

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 4 3
♥ 9 2
♦ A J 8 7
♣ Q 8 7

♠ K 9 5

♥ 10 6

♦ K 10 3 2

♣ J 10 5 4



♠ A Q 7

♥ K 8 4

♦ Q 6 4

♣ K 9 6 3

♠ 8 6 2

♥ A Q J 7 5 3

♦ 9 5

♣ A 2

South opens 1♥. What should we bid? We respond 1NT, just as in standard bidding. The difference is that in this case the 1NT response is forcing on South. South rebids ♥s, promising at least a 6-card suit.

You have nothing to say over 2♥ except pass. Notice that this is the same bidding and same final contract that would have been reached with standard bidding. Using 2/1 is often like that.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♥
All Pass			

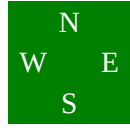
Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 4
♥ A 5 3 2
♦ 4 2
♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A Q 10 9 5
♥ 10 9 6
♦ K 10 8 6
♣ A



♠ 7 3
♥ K Q J
♦ J 3
♣ K 10 8 6 4 3

♠ K J 2
♥ 8 7 4
♦ A Q 9 7 5
♣ Q 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

How do you open the bidding? You open 1 ♠. South responds 2 ♦, a natural 2/1 force to game. What do you rebid?

You cannot rebid your ♠s, but you have decent support for partner's ♦s, so raise to 3 ♦. You are in a game forcing auction so it won't end there. South always intended to play a ♠ contract. He now bids 4 ♠, using Fast Arrival to indicate he has no slam aspirations. 4 ♠ is cold, and if the defenders don't take their ♥ tricks immediately you will make an overtrick.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 4 3

♥ Q

♦ A 6 4 2

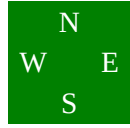
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J 10 6

♥ 9

♦ 8 5 3

♣ K Q J 9 5 2



♠ Q 8 5

♥ J 10 6 5 3 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ A

♠ K 9 2

♥ A K 8 7 4

♦ K 10 7

♣ 10 8

South opens 1♥ and West Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2♣ without fear that South will think you have a strong hand. South also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Dbl

2♣¹

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ A 10 6 5 3
 ♦ 10 5 4
 ♣ 10 9 5 4

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ K 7 3

♣ -



♠ 10 3
 ♥ 9 8 4
 ♦ A 9
 ♣ Q 8 7 6 3 2

♠ Q J 2

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 8 6 2

♣ A K J

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠

All Pass

South would have shown one Ace and North wouldn't know what to do next. She might have figured the odds favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. South responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. South agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). South bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

South's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. North realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that North did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces,